



Farming in Reef Catchments Rebate Scheme Guidelines

1. About the scheme

The objective of the Farming in Reef Catchments Rebate Scheme is to help sugarcane, beef cattle and banana producers in the Great Barrier Reef regions offset the cost of obtaining professional advice about managing nutrient and sediment pollution in line with minimum practice agricultural standards for improved water quality outcomes for the Great Barrier Reef. For more information about the minimum practice agricultural standards go to <http://www.qld.gov.au/ReefRegulations>.

2. Available funding

2.1 Assistance available under this scheme is a rebate up to \$1,000.

3. Eligibility criteria

3.1 To claim the rebate, you must –

- a) be a *primary producer* operating a *primary production enterprise* on land that is *substantially* in the *eligible area*;
- b) have received the *eligible professional advice* no earlier than one year before the scheme commenced from an *Accredited Agricultural Adviser* at the time of application and who is not:
 - i. related to you; or
 - ii. employed by an entity owned or partially owned by you;
- c) have been a primary producer on the *primary production enterprise* when the advice was received;
- d) not have already claimed the rebate in relation to the *primary production enterprise*; and
- e) not have received any assistance from Australian or Queensland Government programs around managing nutrient and sediment run-off on your commercial agricultural property.

4. How to claim

4.1 Claims for the Farming in Reef Catchments Rebate, can be made via:

- a) the Queensland Rural and Industry Development Authority's (QRIDA) online application portal at <https://applyonline.qrida.qld.gov.au/login>; or
- b) paper-based claims can be made using official claim forms available from QRIDA's website at www.qrida.qld.gov.au, and submitted via post, email or facsimile.



4.2 All forms should be submitted to QRIDA and must be accompanied by -

- a) a copy of the *eligible professional advice*;
- b) a tax invoice and a document showing full payment for the *eligible professional advice*;
- c) a disclaimer from an AAA stating advice has been provided in line with Information for Accredited Agricultural Adviser Program Applicants, for the purposes of seeking a rebate under the Farming in Reef Catchments Rebate Scheme.
- d) A recent copy of your local council rates notice for the land the *primary production enterprise* is on.

5. Claim assessment

5.1 QRIDA will assess claims in order of receipt. Incomplete claim forms or claims without the correct supporting documentation will not be processed.

5.2 QRIDA may ask you to provide any additional information required to assess your claim.

5.3 QRIDA will pay rebate amounts approved to the bank account nominated in your claim.

6. Terms and conditions

6.1 The availability of the Farming in Reef Catchments Rebate Scheme is subject to funds being available.

6.2 All information provided must be true and accurate.

7. More information

For more information on the Farming in Reef Catchments Rebate Scheme contact QRIDA on **Freecall 1800 623 946** or email FiRC@qrda.qld.gov.au.

8. Definitions

Agricultural ERA standards means the *Environmental Protection Act 1994*, section 81(1).

Applicant means a person applying for financial assistance under the Farming in Reef Catchments Rebate Scheme.

Approved Agricultural Adviser means a person-

- a) whom QRIDA considers has the appropriate qualifications and experience to give *eligible professional advice*; and
- b) who is listed on QRIDA's website as an Accredited Agricultural Adviser.

Eligible area means the Wet Tropics, Burdekin, Mackay Whitsunday, Fitzroy and Burnett Mary Regions shown as the Great Barrier Reef catchment on the map, held by the Department of Environment and Science, called 'Great Barrier Reef catchment and river basins' dated 23 August 2018.



For this scheme the *primary production enterprise* is within the *eligible area* if:

- a) the *primary production enterprise* is on land located within the following regions:
 - Wet Tropics;
 - Burdekin;
 - Mackay Whitsunday;
 - Fitzroy; and
 - Burnett Mary; and
- b) at least 75% of the area of the land or 20,000ha of land in the lot, is within the eligible area listed above.

Eligible professional advice means written advice-

- a) about managing nutrient and sediment pollution in the *eligible area* in a way –
 - i. that contributes to achieving the targets for water quality improvement for the Great Barrier Reef under the Reef 2050 Water Quality Improvement Plan 2017-2022; and
 - ii. that complies with an agricultural ERA standard that applies to the *primary production enterprise* to which the advice relates; and
- b) mentioning actions that may be taken to contribute to achieving the targets and complying with the standards.

Note: Examples of the type of advice that would be covered under the scheme are listed by industry in Appendix 1

Primary producer means-

- a) a sole trader who spends the majority of his or her labour on, and derives the majority of his or her income from, a *primary production enterprise*; or
- b) in relation to a partnership, *proprietary company* or trust that carries on a *primary production enterprise*, the partners in the partnership, shareholder in the company or trustee or beneficiaries of the trust who spend the majority of his or her labour on and derives the majority of his or her income from, the *primary production enterprise*.

Primary production enterprise means a business-

- a) that involves *primary production* in any of the following forms-
 - i. beef cattle grazing; or
 - ii. cultivating bananas; or
 - iii. cultivating sugarcane; and
- b) for which an entity holds an Australian Business Number.

Proprietary company means a *proprietary company* within the meaning of the *Corporations Act 2001* (Cth).

Substantially means at least 75% of the area of the land or 20,000ha of land in the lot, is within the eligible area.



Appendix 1: Eligible professional advice by industry

Sugarcane

Advice for sugarcane growers would help growers meet the *Agricultural ERA standard for sugarcane cultivation- Version 1* created under the *Environmental Protection Act 1994*, and include:

- provision of a Nitrogen and Phosphorus Budget providing balanced crop nutritional and ameliorant recommendations, which would include:
 - a map of blocks or management zones outlining the area, crop class, potential/historical yield and fertiliser application rates;
 - identification of physical and chemical constraints to yield e.g. waterlogged/sodic/acidic soils, compaction, poor yielding areas;
 - nitrogen (N) and phosphorus (P) recommendations for each block/management zone that do not exceed the amount calculated using the follow methods prescribed under the *Environmental Protection Act 1994* (Qld) including:
 - the method for calculating the amount of N and P to be applied to for sugarcane properties regulated under the *Environmental Protection Act 1994* (Qld);
 - the method for soil sampling and analysis for sugarcane properties regulated under the *Environmental Protection Act 1994* (Qld).
 - calculation of the whole of farm amount (for nitrogen and/or phosphorus) for each 12 month period with the application rate of fertiliser applied to the relevant agricultural property does not exceed the whole of farm amount;
 - the planning format enables record keeping e.g. for fertiliser application rates, soil testing etc.

Bananas

Advice for banana growers would help growers meet the *Agricultural ERA standard for banana cultivation- version 1* created under the *Environmental Protection Act 1994*, and include:

- provision of a Nutrient Management Plan providing balanced crop nutritional and ameliorant recommendations and the plan must include:
 - leaf sampling, analysis and N and P recommendations in line with leaf analysis results;
 - farm maps that clearly outline blocks or management zones to be fertilised, block area, crop class and farm yield; and
 - the planning format enables record keeping e.g. for fertiliser application rates, soil test results etc.
- maintaining inter-row cover of at least 60%;
- measures that minimise the release of soil to receiving waters, for example:



- ☐ location and design of diversion banks; contour banks; surface water drainage structures designed to reduce run-off velocity (e.g. wide vegetated spoon drains); sediment traps or similar structures; or
- ☐ design and maintenance of vegetated buffers to trap sediment prior to entering waterways; or
- ☐ any other measure that minimises the release of soil to receiving waters.

Beef cattle

Advice for beef cattle graziers would help graziers meet the *Agricultural ERA standard for beef cattle grazing- version 1* created under the *Environmental Protection Act 1994*, and include:

- improving poor or degraded land condition (eg. implementing improved forage budgeting or soil conservation plans);
- appropriate measures to take to improve land condition and best practice implementation techniques;
- property specific advice on:
 - ☐ pasture and/or stocking rate management to improve land condition;
 - ☐ design, construction and maintenance of infrastructure to improve land condition (eg. fencing, watering points and roads and tracks);
 - ☐ land condition management/improvement for areas around severe erosion or scalded areas; and/or
 - ☐ land condition management/improvement for degraded areas.